

in bright daylight and dipped to just 1 nit in dark environments.

When fiddling around with the settings, I found an always-on display option, but no toggle in the menu. What's up there, no one knows.

The 60Hz display, rather, the lack of ProMotion is again a pain point that Apple has not addressed and if you are coming from a higher refresh rate screen, you will definitely notice the difference.

PERFORMANCE

When it comes to the performance, Apple has aced it yet again. In the price range, the iPhone 16 is one of the best performing phones of all time! If you are one for the numbers, in AnTuTu, the phone scored - 16,31,715. In other benchmarks like 3D Mark, GFX bench, and Geekbench, again, the scores were impressive, and as you can see, the delta between the competing Samsung and Google flagships is almost always in favour of the iPhone 16. The storage is also snappy and even trumped its beefier cousin, the 16 Pro Max in our PC Mark sequential write test.

Now with the numbers out of the way, let's talk about the real-world performance. Be it opening and closing apps, running fairly heavy applications or even gaming, the iPhone 16 does the job really well. CoD mobile with Max settings works really well. There were a few frame drops once the phone heated up, but nothing major.

Given that Apple is positioning its new iPhones as the All-in-one creator-centric device, I used Adobe Premier Rush to render a quick 4K video, and the phone handled it with ease. I even hooked it up to a monitor using a USB C Cable for live preview when using the App, and even that task was a breeze for the iPhone 16. Staying on the topic of content creation with the iPhone 16, let's talk about its camera performance.

CAMERA

The Apple iPhone 16 comes with a dual camera setup in the back, with a 12MP

ultrawide shooter complimenting the 48 MP main shooter, both of which are pretty much the same as the iPhone 15. The iPhone 16's camera shined bright in well-lit environments, be it selfies, portraits or scenery shots taken on the phone. The edge detection in natural light portraits is fairly on point, and the details and the dynamic range in complex scenarios are pretty well presented. In night-time photography, though, the iPhone 16 struggled a bit.

When shooting scenes, the phone retained details and the dynamic range pretty well, but as you can see in this picture of my Jordans, there was pretty bad artifacting taking place when I switched to the ultra-wide camera. The phone tried to detail the shoe but failed spectacularly. I switched on the flash in favour of the 3-second shutter speed, and the results improved immediately.

As for the videos, the iPhone 16 pretty much does the job really well when it comes to recording videos. The videos are sharp, have detail in well-lit conditions, and a little bit of noise that creeps in at night or in poorly lit environments, but all in all, it is manageable. All in all, the iPhone's prowess as a camera-centric phone, which has the potential to be a one-stop destination for the creators, is shining through on the iPhone 16. The camera app itself has gotten a fair bit of customisations for the power users out there, bagging a few brownie points for Apple here.

BATTERY LIFE

The iPhone 16 packs a 3561 mAh battery capable of fast charging which will top up the battery to 50 per cent in just half an hour. In real world applications, using a 45W PD charger, I was able to charge the phone from zero to 100 in 98 minutes.

If you are a fan of wireless charging, then you will get 25W of fast charging using the MagSafe puck, and 15W with a Qi2 certified charger.

Again, for the fan of the stats, the iPhone 16 in our test, lasted around 18 hours in our 4K video loop test and reported fairly minimal drops in bat-

tery in our gaming and GPS navigation tests.

In real world, this translates to about one and a half days of power if you are a light user, mostly texting on your phone and in a good cellular and WiFi reception area. If you are a power user, shooting, editing and gaming on your iPhone 16, then you might be able to squeeze out about 7-8 hours of battery with some power management

VERDICT

So, should you buy the iPhone 16?

The answer is YES, and NO.

Yes, for the folks who are looking for the latest and greatest iPhones in their pocket which performs better than what they would need in the real world and is a capable camera and content creation tool. The camera app has a set of new features that will let you move back to the native app if you are someone who likes granular control over your videos and photos, and the microphones are fairly well tuned to capture audio to compliment your videos well.

But, if Apple Intelligence was a selling point for you, I would say wait. Until Apple releases the full version of Apple Intelligence globally, you should not bother getting the iPhone 16. By the time it rolls around, you will see a couple of online sales pass by and the price will drop. Then it would make sense to invest your hard-earned money towards the "latest and greatest" iPhone.

—Satvik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 147.6 x 71.6 x 7.8 mm (5.81 x 2.82 x 0.31 in) | Weight: 170 g (6.00 oz) | Build: Glass front (Corning-made glass), glass back (Corning-made glass), aluminum frame | SIM: Nano-SIM and eSIM - International | Display: Super Retina XDR OLED, HDR10 | Display Size: 6.1 inches | Display Resolution: 1179 x 2556 pixels, 19.5:9 ratio (~460 ppi density) | IP68 dust/water resistant (up to 6m for 30 min) | Platform: OS | Chipset: Apple A18 (3 nm) | CPU: Hexa-core (2x4.04 GHz + 4x2.20 GHz) | GPU: Apple GPU (5-core graphics)

CONTACT

Company: Apple | Phone: 008001009009 | Email: NA | Website: <https://www.apple.com/in/>